CHAPTER SIX:
BUILDING TOMORROW

As much as Iron Man 2 is about the man, we can't forget the iron—the technology that Tony Stark forges. Sometimes the technology is big and splashy, like the Iron Man armor. Sometimes it's more humble. But in a film like this, it all has to be created.

No piece of tech makes it onto the screen unconsidered. The artists visualize the tech, the director and producer and production designer review and ask for revisions—until the piece is finally ready for the world of Iron Man. Many of these elements need to be built, and that's where Prop Master Russell Bobbitt comes in.

"An interesting challenge that I always have as a prop guy," says Bobbitt, "is that I've never seen the same day twice—so every single day is a new challenge for me. If I make the coolest prop in the world, 14 people say, 'Well, can't you do this with it?' And I'm the guy that can't say no, so… And I like that. It's what lights me up and it's why I do what I do. It's constantly a new thing, a new challenge. If I want to see Iron Man 3, I better pull it off."

"You want it to look a little bit like it belongs in the real world. You start getting too sci-fi, you start losing the audience," says Production Designer Michael Riva. But there is a balance between the mundane and the futuristic that must be maintained. "I think we live in a world—in Tony Stark World—where everything should be prototypical of stuff that's coming in the next three or four years."

The following pages present a glimpse into the world that exists inside Tony Stark's imagination.



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